



BITING THE BULLET

Ammunition shortages have turned preparation into a balancing act, with Indian shooters saving their newer stock for the Asian Games.

Santadeep Dey
santadeep.dey@thehindu.co.in

An ammunition supply crunch has left Indian shooters training with ageing bullets to preserve the newer, year-old stock for the upcoming Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya. For the 50m rifle 3 positions shooters, the problem is particularly acute. Most use Midas Plus and X-ACT, two premium variants of .22 Long Rifle (5.6mm) rimfire ammunition manufactured by Lapua.

The military adoption of .338 Magnum sniper systems by Ukrainian forces during the Russian invasion and other wartime demands severely crippled Lapua's global commercial manufacturing. In a statement from 2022, the Finnish company acknowledged the issue: "To better

serve our civilian and military obligations, some of our components will be temporarily suspended from production. This is due to prioritising production lines. Some Lapua products will probably be out of stock in many places in the world for some time to come."

What was already a cumbersome procurement process has become more arduous. Shooters first secure an appointment with Lapua for barrel testing, during which multiple ammunition lots are fired to